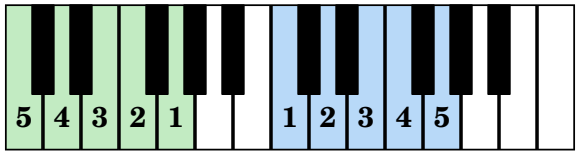
Unit 3

Hands Take Turns

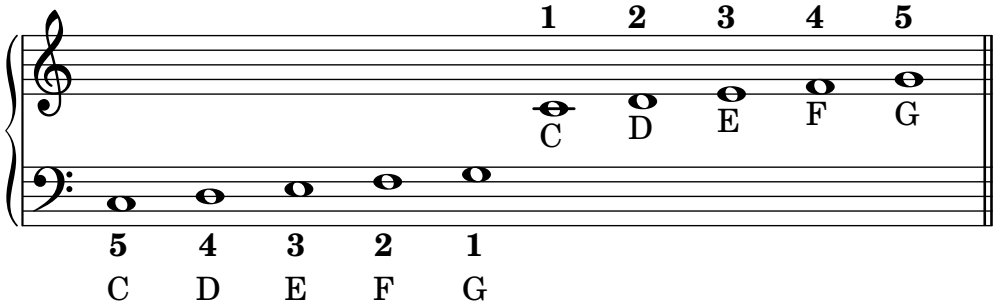
New: Melody passes between hands; 3/4 time and the dotted half note

From now on both hands sit in C position at the same time: the left hand on C to G below middle C, the right hand on C to G from middle C. In this unit they take turns. One hand plays while the other waits, resting on its keys and ready. You will also meet a new time signature, 3/4.



Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Taking turns

The melody moves from one staff to the other. When it moves to the bass staff, the left hand plays; when it moves back up, the right hand plays.

Full-bar rests

A bar with only a rest in it means that hand is silent for the whole bar. In every time signature this is the whole-rest sign, a small block hanging under the fourth line.

3/4 time

Three beats in every bar. Count 1 - 2 - 3, and lean a little on beat 1, like a waltz.

The dotted half note

A dot adds half of the note's value: a half note (2 beats) plus its dot (1 beat) makes 3 beats, a full bar in 3/4.

Reading tips

1. Look ahead to the bar where the melody changes staff. Know which hand plays next before you get there.

2. The resting hand stays on its five keys, so it can start without looking down.

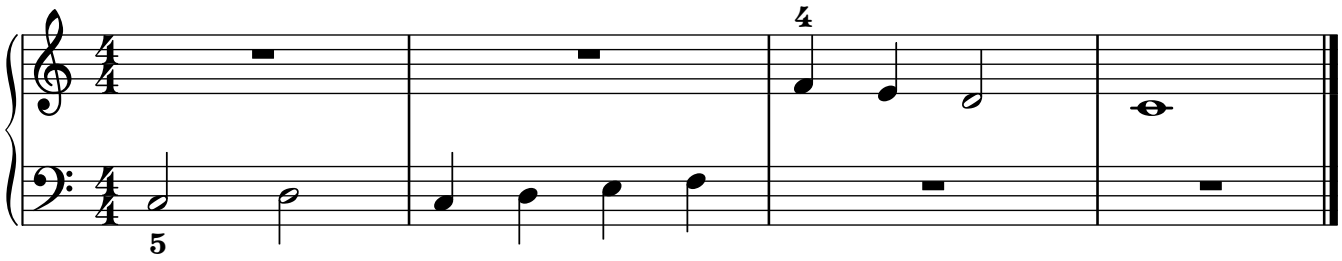
3. In 3/4, keep counting 1 - 2 - 3 right through a dotted half note. It is easy to cut it short to two beats.

4. As always: keep the beat going, even after a mistake.

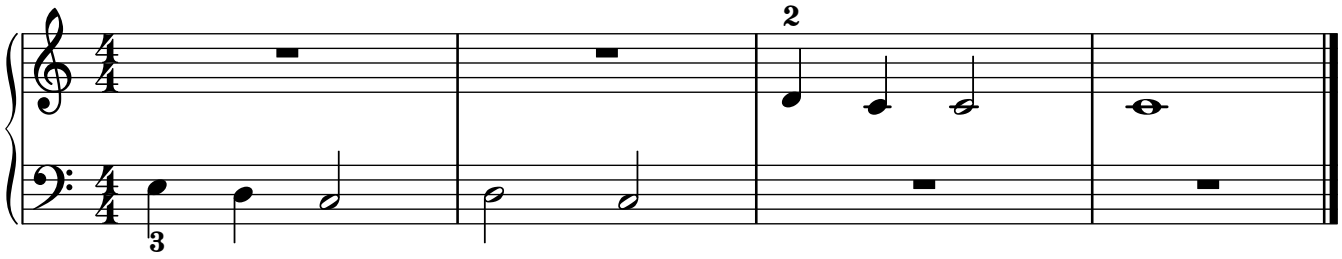
Part A: Two bars each ♩ = 60

The melody passes between the hands every two bars. 4/4 time, metronome 60.

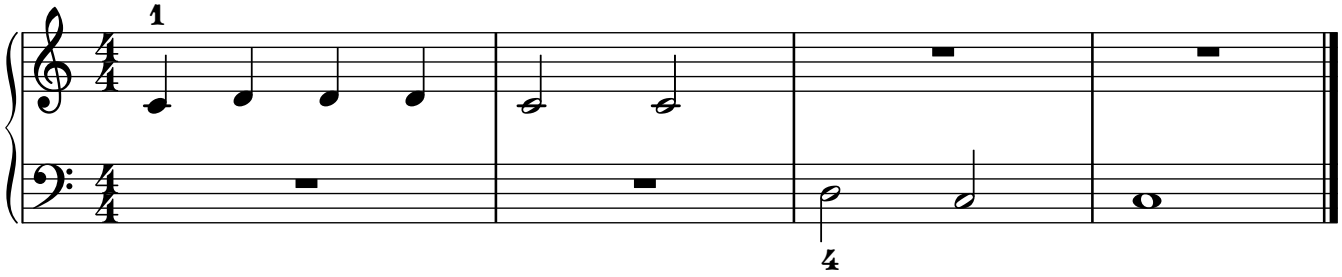
☐ **3.1**



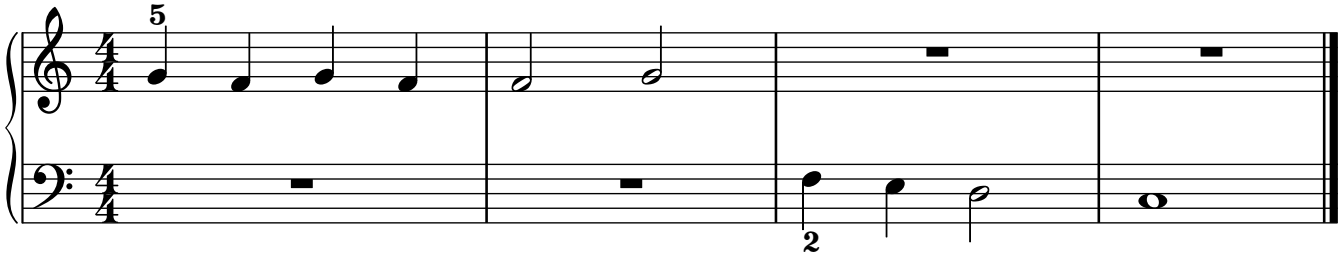
☐ **3.2**



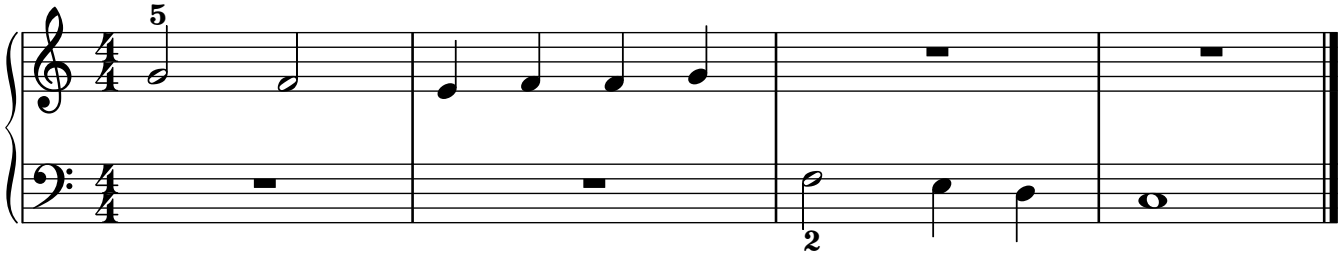
☐ **3.3**



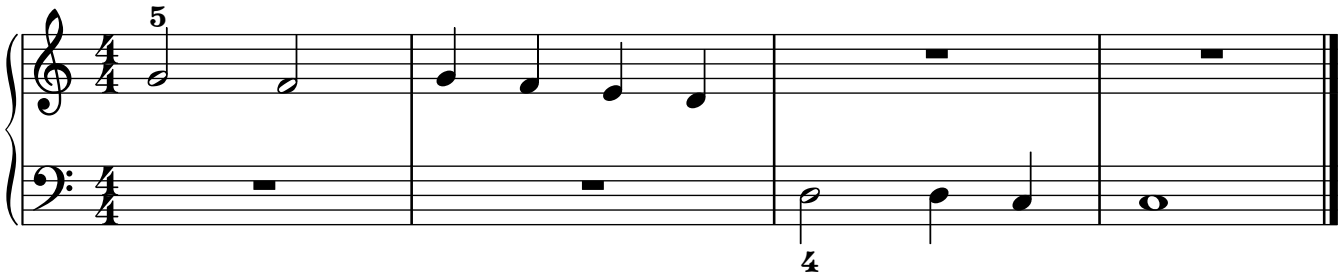
☐ **3.4**



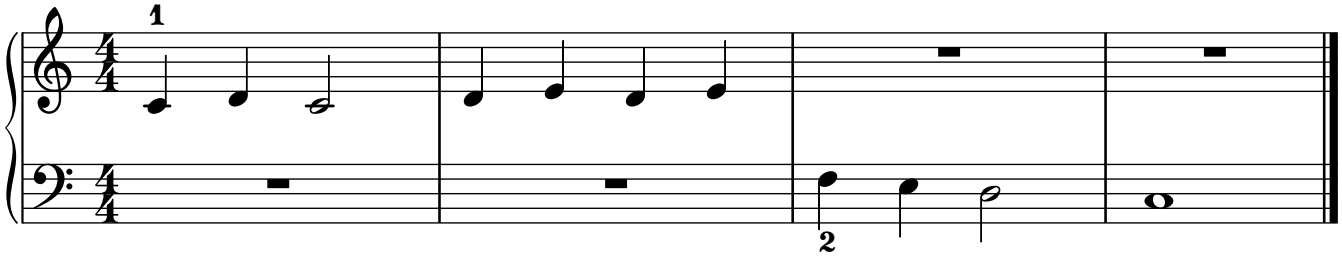
☐ **3.5**



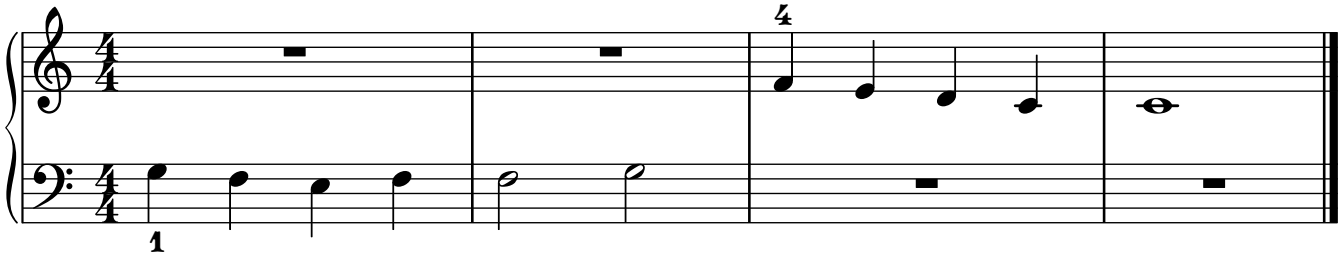
☐ **3.6**



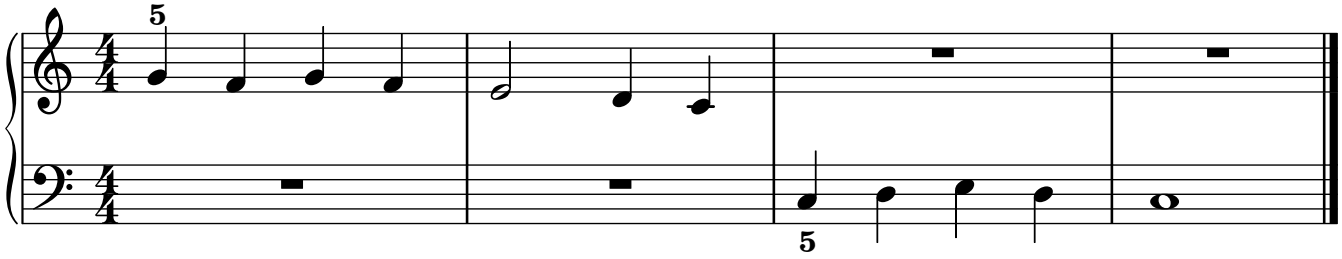
☐ **3.7**



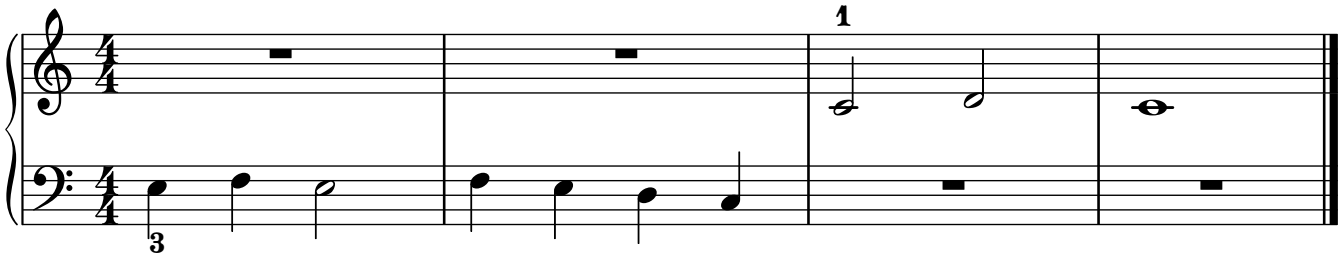
☐ **3.8**



☐ **3.9**



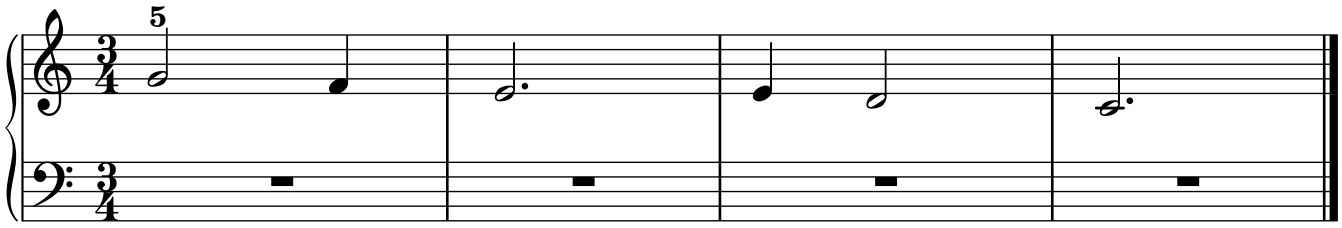
☐ **3.10**



Part B: Three beats in a bar ♩ = 72

3/4 time, right hand only. New rhythm: the dotted half note, worth three beats.

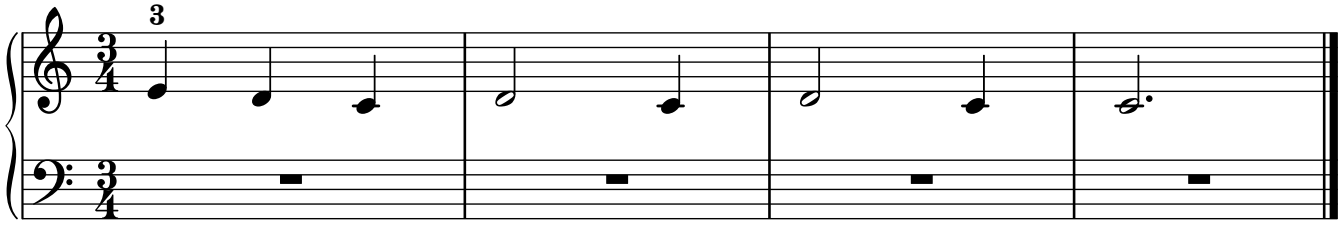
☐ **3.11**



☐ **3.12**



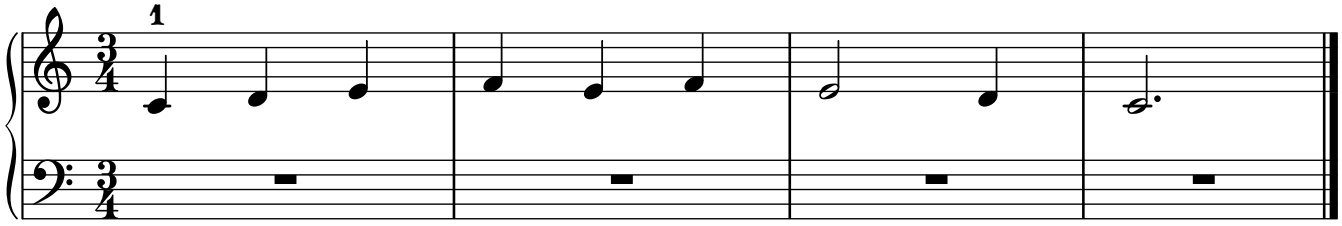
☐ **3.13**



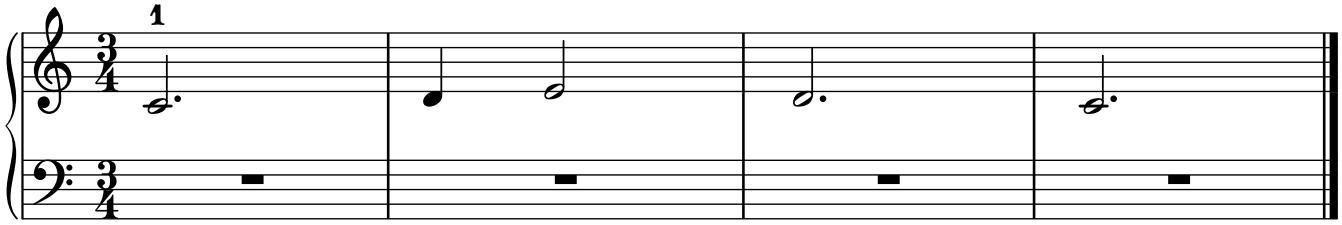
☐ **3.14**



☐ **3.15**



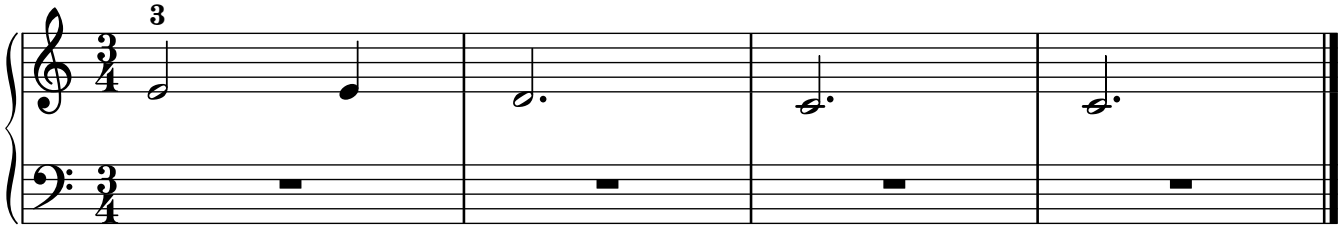
☐ **3.16**



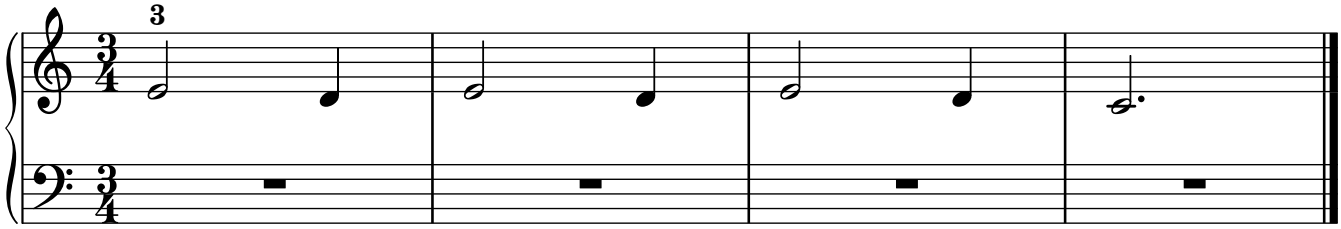
3.17



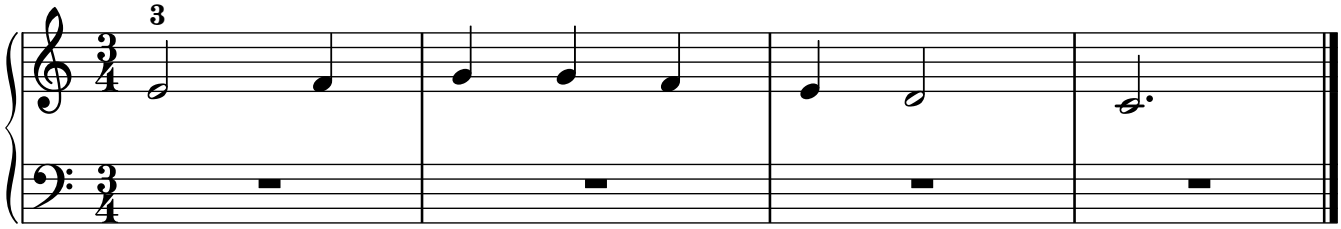
3.18



3.19



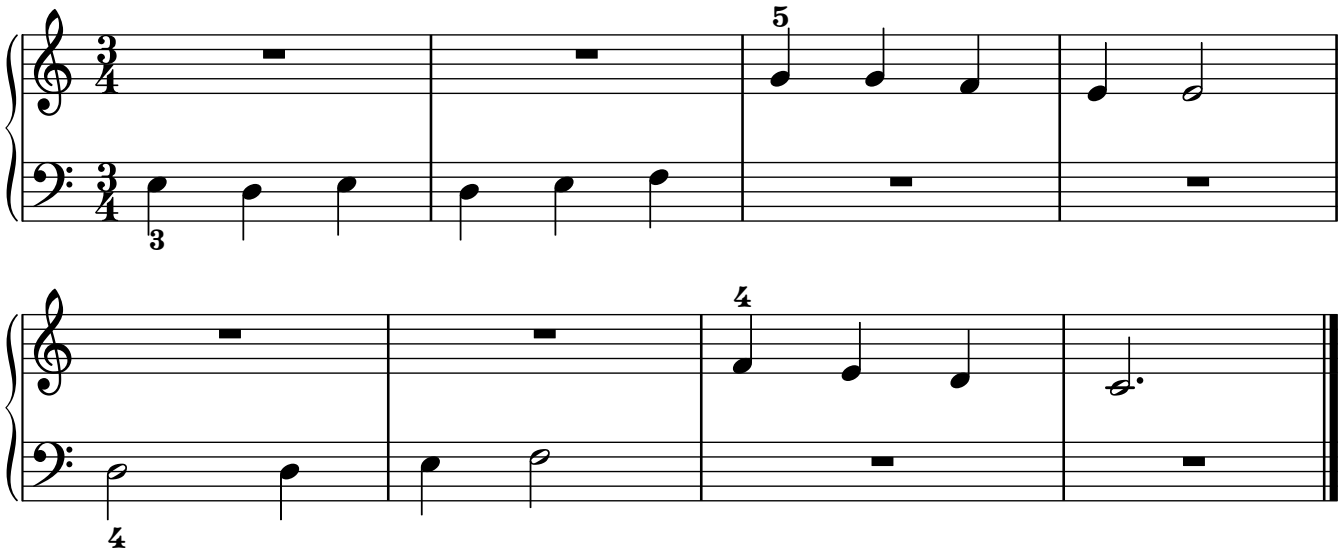
3.20



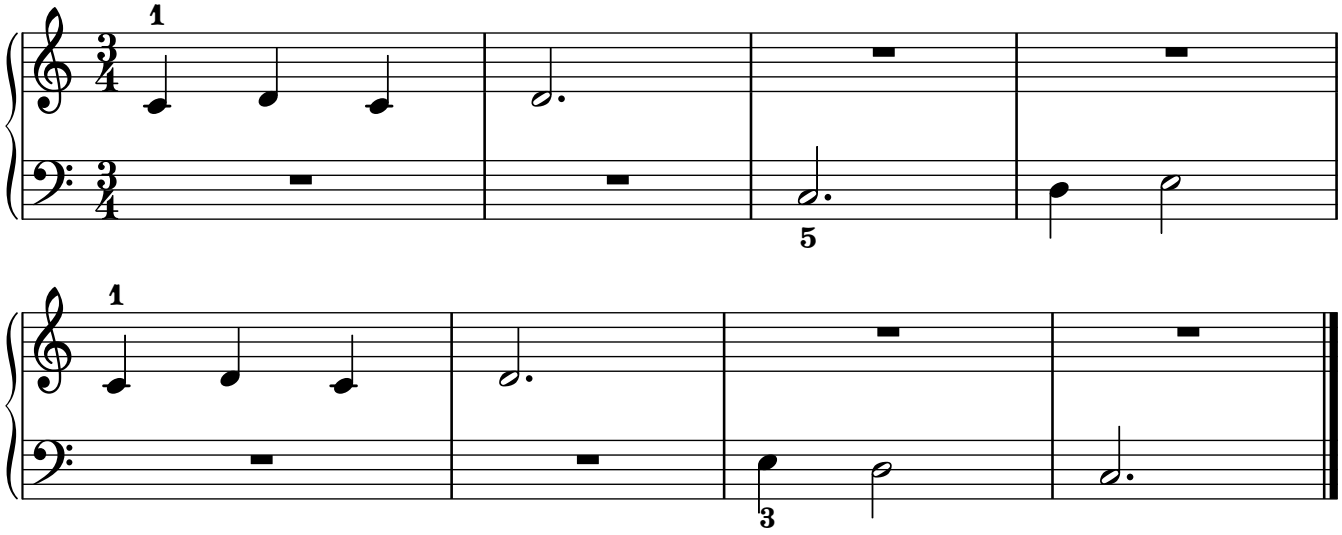
Part C: Turns in 3/4 ♩ = 72

Eight-bar phrases in 3/4, with the hands taking turns.

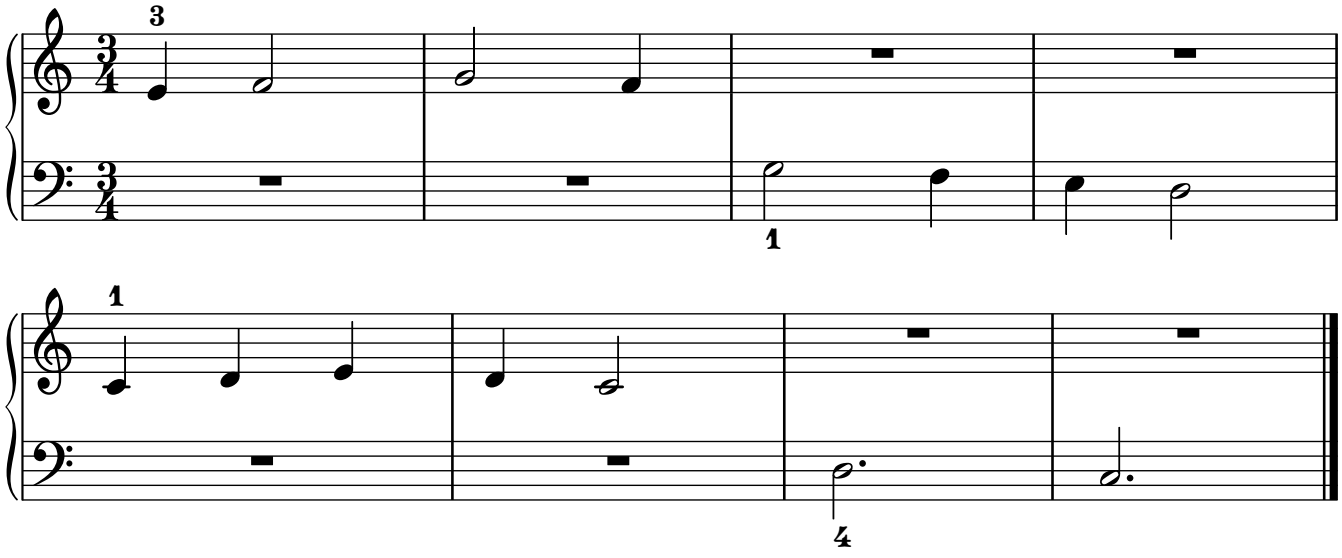
☐ **3.21**



☐ **3.22**



☐ **3.23**



3.24



3.25



3.26



3.27



3.28



3.29



3.30



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Echo ♩ = 72

Original

The left hand echoes the right hand an octave lower. Play the echo a little softer.



Waltz for Two Hands ♩ = 84

Original

One, two, three. The tune passes from hand to hand every two bars. Hold each dotted half note for all three beats.



The Swing ♩ = 80

Original

The right hand swings down from G, then the left hand answers from its own G.



Ode to Joy (shared) ♩ = 80

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

The right hand plays the first half and the left hand finishes the tune. Be ready to start the left hand in bar 5.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 72 beats per minute.
- Pass if the beat never stops when the melody changes hands.
- Pass if every dotted half note gets its full three beats, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4. If not, read more Part A and C exercises in a week.